

# AWC 10-Year Performance Analysis Capstone

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## **Project Overview**

This project analyzes 10 years of student performance indicators (AY 2015–2016 through AY 2024–2025) at Arizona Western College (AWC). The goal is to identify trends in enrollment, demographics, and student outcomes to support data-driven decision making.

This analysis follows the six-step data analysis process: Ask, Prepare, Process, Analyze, Share, and Act.

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## **Business Task (Ask)**

### **Objective**

Evaluate long-term trends in student enrollment, demographics, and performance to answer:

- How has student enrollment changed over time?
- What demographic shifts are occurring?
- Are student success and completion rates improving?

### **Stakeholders**

- AWC Leadership
  - Office of Institutional Effectiveness and Research
  - Enrollment Management
  - Academic Departments
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## **Data Sources (Prepare)**

Private Dataset provided by AWC Admission's office

Internal AWC dataset compiled into a 10-Year Performance Indicators report.

### **Data Includes**

- Student Headcount & FTSE
- Enrollment Status (full-time vs part-time)
- Demographics (race/ethnicity, age, gender)

- Early College & Dual Credit participation
- Academic success & withdrawal rates
- Graduates and credentials awarded

### **Data Structure**

- Time-series format (Academic Year)
- Aggregated counts and percentages

### **Data Integrity (ROCCC)**

-  Reliable – Institutional data source
  -  Original – Directly from AWC systems
  -  Comprehensive – Covers 10-year period
  -  Current – Includes most recent academic year
  -  Cited – Produced by Office of Institutional Effectiveness & Research
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### **Data Cleaning (Process)**

#### **Tools Used**

- Access
- Excel
- PowerPoint (source validation)

#### **Cleaning Steps**

- Standardized academic year formats
  - Converted decimals to percentage format
  - Reviewed definitions (FTSE, success rate, etc.)
  - Accounted for COVID-19 anomalies (2020–2021)
  - Checked for consistency across tables and visuals
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### **Analysis Summary (Analyze)**

#### **Enrollment Growth**

- Student Headcount increased by **16%**
- FTSE increased by **10%**

- Temporary decline during COVID-19, followed by recovery

**Insight:** AWC demonstrates long-term growth despite disruption.

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### **Early College & Dual Credit Expansion**

- Early College: **+668% growth**
- Dual Credit: **+673% growth**

**Insight:** High school partnerships are a major driver of enrollment growth.

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### **Demographic Trends**

- Latino student population increased significantly (~73%+)
- Caucasian population decreased over time

**Insight:** AWC is increasingly serving a Hispanic-majority population.

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### **Student Age Trends**

- Average age decreased by **3 years**
- Median age decreased by **3 years**

**Insight:** Student body is getting younger, influenced by dual enrollment programs.

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### **Enrollment Behavior**

- **81% of students attend part-time**

**Insight:** Flexible scheduling is critical for student success.

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### **Academic Outcomes**

- Success rate improved from ~77% to **82%**
- Withdrawal rates slightly decreased

**Insight:** Academic performance is steadily improving.

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### **Graduation & Credentials**

- Graduates increased by **20%**

- Credentials increased by **18%**
- Degrees grew faster than certificates (**+30%**)

**Insight:** More students are completing programs, especially degree pathways.

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## Data Visualizations (Share)

### 1. Student Headcount Trend

**What it shows:** Growth over time and COVID dip

**Why it matters:** Demonstrates resilience and long-term growth

### 2. Early College & Dual Credit Growth

**What it shows:** Rapid growth in participation

**Why it matters:** Identifies key enrollment driver

### 3. Student Success Rate Trend

**What it shows:** Improvement in outcomes

**Why it matters:** Reflects effectiveness of academic support strategies

*(Visuals sourced from original PowerPoint presentation)*

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## Recommendations (Act)

### 1. Expand Early College & Dual Credit Programs

**Action:** Increase partnerships with high schools and course offerings

### 2. Strengthen Support for Part-Time Students

**Action:** Expand online courses, flexible schedules, and advising services

### 3. Enhance Culturally Responsive Services

**Action:** Develop bilingual support, outreach programs, and targeted resources for Latino students

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## Conclusion

This analysis highlights strong enrollment growth, shifting demographics, and improving student outcomes at AWC. The institution's future success depends on leveraging early college programs, supporting part-time learners, and adapting to an increasingly diverse student population.

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